

Aqib Arif

Java Backend Developer | Java Microservices | Spring & Hibernate | FIX Protocol | Low-Latency Trading Systems

Mannheim, Germany | Open to Relocation | EU Work Permit

📞 +49 170 9017689 | ✉️ aqib.arif7@gmail.com | 🏠 aqibarif.github.io | 📄 aqib-arif-7b5083185

Professional Summary

Java Backend Developer with 6+ years of experience building high-performance, low-latency backend systems for regulated financial markets. Delivered FIX protocol integrations connecting directly to live exchange trading engines, alongside real-time order book infrastructure consumed by trading front-ends. Strong background in Spring, Hibernate, and Java microservices, with experience owning services end-to-end — from architectural design and code reviews through to production support. Comfortable working within Agile/Scrum teams, integrating third-party APIs, and mentoring engineers. Currently balancing two concurrent roles: backend engineering on a regulated UK mortgage platform, and backend/AI-integration work in a safety-critical automotive environment.

Technical Skills

Trading & Market Data	FIX protocol (FIX dictionary, tag-level message parsing), tick-by-tick feed processing, Market-by-Symbol order book construction, low-latency socket streaming, real-time market data & news integration
Java Microservices & Backend	Java 17/21, Spring, Spring Boot, Hibernate/JPA, Maven, REST API design, third-party API integration, event-driven architecture, JMS, React (working knowledge)
Delivery & Collaboration	Agile/Scrum, architectural design, code reviews, Git, CI/CD (Bamboo, Jenkins, GitLab), Jira, Confluence, mentoring junior engineers
Data, Messaging & Cloud Reliability	PostgreSQL, MySQL, Kafka, Redis, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, JUnit, integration testing Structured logging, distributed tracing, MTTR reduction, production incident resolution

Professional Experience

Quantum Mortgages, Remote UK

Jan 2025 – Present

Java Backend Engineer

- Develop and maintain an in-house backend platform that calculates mortgage costs for customers in real time, integrating live with UK government rate data to inform loan approval and regulatory disclosure decisions.
- Build and ship production-quality Java microservices as part of a cross-functional team on a regulated financial platform processing 50K+ daily events, participating in architectural design discussions, code reviews, and the full delivery lifecycle from design through deployment.
- Optimise PostgreSQL and MySQL performance through systematic analysis, reducing page load time from 2.5s to under 800ms; implement Redis caching reducing peak database load by 60%.

AnTeCoS GmbH, Waghäusel, Germany

Aug 2024 – Present

Software Engineer

- Deliver backend and tooling work in a safety-critical automotive engineering environment, mentoring and training engineers on secure coding and AI-assisted development practices aligned with functional safety goals.
- Analyse system malfunctions systematically, implementing root-cause fixes; established an automated integration testing framework that reduced manual test cycle time by 35%.

TAPP Engine, Remote USA

Mar 2024 – Dec 2024

Java Backend Engineer

- Engineered backend middleware integrating third-party market data and news APIs — including QuoteMedia and Benzinga — into a US brokerage trading application, streaming live data over sockets to power real-time front-end displays.
- Designed and built event-driven Java microservices for a financial trading platform processing 200K+ market/news events per hour, handling ingestion, normalisation, and low-latency delivery.
- Built structured logging covering 500K+ events daily and distributed tracing that reduced MTTR from 45 to 12 minutes, while driving code review practices across 6 teams that helped cut production incidents from 8 to 2 per month.

Catalyst IT Solutions (Pakistan Stock Exchange engagement), Karachi, Pakistan

Aug 2020 – Feb 2024

Java Backend Developer

- Built a backend server handling the full order lifecycle over live FIX connections to the Pakistan Stock Exchange and the Shenzhen Stock Exchange (SZSE, China) — encoding client orders via QuickFIX/J, routing them to the exchange, and processing execution acknowledgments to confirm fills and status.
- Developed and maintained Market-by-Symbol order book logic, exposing the top 30 price levels per instrument to trading front-ends for real-time depth-of-market visibility.
- Built production Spring Boot microservices and REST APIs for financial systems handling 10K+ daily transactions; reduced regression bugs by 70% through systematic testing.

Education

Technische Universität Ilmenau, Germany

2024 – Present

M.Sc. Computer and Systems Engineering (Ongoing)

SZABIST, Pakistan

2015 – 2019

B.Sc. Computer Science